FREE GUIDE · FROM THE VIDEO

Build your own iPhone app with AI

Everything from the video in one place: what you need, the one-time setup, the exact commands and prompts, and what to know before you share your app.

Your idea plain English → **Claude Code** writes Swift → **Xcode** builds + signs → **USB-C cable** installs → **iPhone** runs your app

What you need

Hardware

- [ ] **A Mac** (MacBook or any Mac). Xcode only runs on macOS.
- [ ] **An iPhone** and its passcode.
- [ ] **A USB-C (or Lightning) data cable.** Charge-only cables won't show the phone.

Software & accounts

- [ ] **Apple ID**, and know its password.
- [ ] **Xcode**, free on the Mac App Store (large download, plan for 10+ GB of space).
- [ ] **An AI coding tool.** I use **Claude Code**; Codex, Antigravity or similar work too.

You don't need to know Swift or iOS development. You describe the app; the AI writes the code, builds it with Xcode and installs it. Your job is the one-time setup on the next page and testing on your phone.

Two ways to build

1 · From scratch

You have an idea → describe it → Claude builds it.

2 · Clone an app you pay for

Screen-record the app → "build this for me" → your own version, free.

DO THIS ONCE

One-time setup

1 Install Xcode

1. Mac App Store → search **Xcode** → Get. This is the slowest part (several GB).
2. Open Xcode once, accept the licence and let it install the **iOS platform** when asked.
3. Check it from Terminal:

```
$ xcode-select -p          # should print /Applications/Xcode.app/Contents/Developer
$ xcodebuild -version      # prints the Xcode version
# if the first one points somewhere else:
$ sudo xcode-select -s /Applications/Xcode.app/Contents/Developer
```

2 Sign in to Xcode with your Apple ID

Xcode › **Settings...** › **Apple Accounts** › **+ sign in with your Apple ID**

This creates your free "Personal Team". Apps you build are signed with it, which is how your iPhone knows who made them.

3 Connect your iPhone

1. Plug the iPhone into the Mac with the **data** cable, unlock it, tap **Trust This Computer**.
2. Check that the Mac sees it:

```
$ xcrun devicectl list devices
# Name     Model                State
# iPhone   iPhone 18 Pro Max     connected   ← you want "connected"
```

4 Turn on Developer Mode (on the iPhone)

Settings › **Privacy & Security** › **Developer Mode** › **On**

The iPhone restarts. After it boots, confirm **Turn On** and enter your passcode. Don't see the toggle? Connect the phone to the Mac with Xcode open first; it appears after that.

5 Install Claude Code

```
# needs Node.js 18+
$ npm install -g @anthropic-ai/claude-code
$ mkdir ~/Desktop/MyApp && cd ~/Desktop/MyApp
$ claude                   # sign in, then start typing what you want
```

BUILD IT

Prompts & first launch

1 Your first prompt

> **"I want to build a teleprompter app, basic one, and install it on my iPhone."**

Claude checks your Xcode setup, creates a SwiftUI project, builds it for your connected iPhone and installs it. It may ask for your iPhone passcode or Mac password on screen. Type those yourself.

2 Trust the developer (first launch only)

If the app says "Untrusted Developer" when you open it:

Settings › **General** › **VPN & Device Management** › **your Apple ID** › **Trust**

3 Add features: the build loop

Ask one feature at a time → **Claude plans** + writes code → **Build & install** same cable → **Test on phone** say what's wrong ↺

> **"Can you add a camera feed as well, where I can record in HD 30 & 60 and 4K 30 & 60?"**

4 Clone an app you already pay for

1. Screen-record the app on your iPhone (Control Centre → Screen Recording). Tap through every screen.
2. AirDrop the recording to your Mac and give it to Claude:

> **"Here's a screen recording of an app I use. Build this as my own iOS app, same screens and features, and install it on my iPhone."**

Build it for yourself. Don't copy another app's name, logo or artwork, and don't publish a clone of someone else's app.

! If something goes wrong

YOU SEE	FIX
iPhone not in `devicectl` list	Use a data cable, unlock the phone, tap Trust This Computer.
"Developer Mode disabled"	Turn it on (page 2, step 4) and restart the phone.
"Untrusted Developer"	Trust your Apple ID (step 2 above).
Signing / team error	Sign in under Xcode › Settings › Apple Accounts, then ask Claude to build again.

BEFORE YOU SHARE IT

App Store vs. just for you

Just for you free Apple ID

- [ ] The app's signature **expires after 7 days**, then it won't open.
- [ ] **Re-sign:** plug in and build/run from Xcode (or ask Claude to "build and install again"). Your data stays.
- [ ] Free accounts can only keep a few self-built apps installed at once.

On the App Store $99 / year

- [ ] Join the **Apple Developer Program**, as an individual or a business.
- [ ] Builds on your own phone last **a full year**.
- [ ] Publish as many apps as you want; **Apple reviews each one**.
- [ ] Selling digital content? Use **In-App Purchase**; Apple keeps 15–30%.

Publishing checklist

- [ ] **App icon** 1024×1024 PNG, no transparency.
- [ ] **A unique app name** (check it isn't taken on the App Store).
- [ ] **Privacy policy URL** and **support URL**. Required even if you collect no data.
- [ ] **Screenshots** for the required iPhone sizes, plus a description and keywords.
- [ ] **App Privacy answers** in App Store Connect (e.g. "Data Not Collected").
- [ ] **Permission texts** for camera, microphone, photos: why your app needs each.
- [ ] Archive in Xcode (**Product › Archive**) → upload → test with **TestFlight** → submit for review.

Ideas to build next: a home-automation remote, a habit or expense tracker, an on-the-go transcriber, or a copy of any app you pay for every month. Tell me in the comments what you built.